GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

January 2nd, 2026
Week 1
Volume 280, Issue 1217

Highlights:

- **India improves.**
- **Maduro capture.**
- **Decisive times.**
- **Price plunge.**
- **Upheaval.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"Keep a little fire burning; however small, however hidden."

– Cormac McCarthy

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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NEW YEAR, W.T. FEARS!

After what only seemed like a calm period while Donald Trump was flailing in the polls amid ongoing scandals and investigations, he ramped it up and brought 2026 in with a literal **BANG** via his latest incursion into — and seizure of — President Nicolas Maduro and his wife from their Presidential Home in Venezuela, in a pre-dawn raid by special-forces. Trump even posted a Polaroid of the handcuffed Maduro, blindfolded, as they landed at a secure / undisclosed facility.

While Trump's true intentions remain unclear (just yet), it's only a matter of time before we see how global / oil / shipping markets react in the coming week(s) to this globally dictatorial move that has most certainly violated a long list of international laws pertaining to sitting presidents and prisoners of war. Moreover, major news outlets are now reporting confusion over who maintains control. Although major news sources report that the U.S. is claiming to hold power over the country, Trump claims the current Venezuelan government (albeit with the President missing and all) will hold interim power while the U.S. administers the nation until such time that a new administration capable of resuming duties is in place to lead the country. Hard to reread that and not think that a prominent three-letter agency was missing some South American sun this frigid time of the year; and after all the geopolitical craziness that gripped — and impacted — us through 2025, I don't know how many were ready to see Trump Theatre & Co. deliver a cake factory to celebrate his madness this soon in 2026.

In the meantime, global economies delivered mixed signals as U.S. stocks maintained a steady decline over the tail-end of December, China's industrial growth slowed, and EU stocks reportedly surged. The U.S. Dollar started the year off-balance against ship recycling currencies, shipowners started to rejoice as the Baltic Exchange Dry Index showed signs of a resurgence, oil continued to slip on its way to USD 60/barrel even though it climbed to USD 57.17/barrel this week, local steel plate prices made no jarring moves beyond the recent trend, and beaching tides delivered twins in both India and Pakistan. At least it was encouraging to see the Indian market display some signs of improvement over the first week of 2026, as busier and less challenging times hopefully lie ahead.

In the ship recycling markets overall, increasingly decisive times lie ahead for Bangladesh as a nation given that impending elections are nearing by the week and the country is being increasingly submerged by political protests, rioting, and instances of violence. Bangladesh levels and demand have plummeted as a result and now lie at the foot of the sub-continent price rankings board, given that Pakistan and India both made improvements as December 2025 ended, and they moved up the ladder. With more upheaval now expected across the world, continued economic and geopolitical shocks may temporarily prop up shipping markets and deprive recycling locations of vintage tonnage for a while longer — it seems as though 2026 is taking on the mantle from 2025!

WE WOULD LIKE TO WISH OUR READERS, A HAPPY NEW YEAR AND ALL THE BEST FOR 2026!

BANGLADESH

PRICE PLUNGE!

USD 50/LDT decline.

Ever since the tonnage engorgement back in November 2025, the Bangladeshi ship recycling market has been on a consistent nosedive, leaving recyclers in Chattogram largely uncompetitive when it comes to offering on the limited number of units currently paraded at the bidding tables. Levels have shockingly come off by about USD 50/LDT since the highs of Q4 2025 — an uncharacteristically rapid, drastic, and unexpected deterioration that has left local demand and overall industry sentiment toward Chattogram on voicemail mode.

Violent protests.

Moreover, with significant uncertainty building ahead of the February elections, violent protests followed the death of youth leader Sharif Osman Hadi, who was shot by masked gunmen while leaving a mosque in Dhaka back in December. The death of Bangladesh's first female PM, Khaleda Zia, last week at the age of 80 also sent much of the country into mourning, as these uncertain and dark times become headline news nationwide.

Violent protests.

Dripping down into the ship recycling sector, the situation clearly remains ever worse, albeit with a lemon-twist surprise at the waterfront, as Chattogram was the only sub-continent destination to report any arrivals — including the nation's first prompt delivery — this week. But on the fundamentals side, things remain scattered: local steel plate prices recorded their usual weekly volatility, while the BDT lost six basis points against the U.S. Dollar and closed the week out at BDT 122.30.

Appealing

Overall, the trajectory of this market over the next couple of months does not seem appealing to the industry, as with price, tonnage follows suit. And it would not be an impossibility to see Far Eastern tonnage heading to shores west of Bangladesh.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

STEEL SURGE!

The Indian market surged by nearly USD 30/LDT over the last week, sending Alang soaring to the top of the price rankings board for the first time in over a quarter, as 2026 began on a far cheerier note than the end of 2025 would otherwise seem to suggest.

Encouraging signs.

Surprisingly, despite the U.S. Dollar gaining 20 basis points against the Indian Rupee and closing the week at Rs. 90.28 – breaching into the dread Rs. 90s once again, demand still managed to improve and, after a fairly woeful 2025, Alang recyclers can be a touch more optimistic heading into what many are hoping will be a far busier year ahead — the perennial prayer of the recycling ports over the last five years that has yet to be answered.

Back top.

Yet, the biggest surprise of the week was local anchorage, which, for the first time in a very long time, reported a deserted theatre — a first for this market. Although in fairness, there are units idling at outer awaiting entry onto the port report so it's only a matter of time before their scoreboard for 2026 starts all over again.

Overall, India is once again the best-placed market to take in tonnage. It seems odd not to mention HKC or "otherwise" anymore, since every vessel has naturally been subject to the Convention since June 26, 2025, when it formally kicked into gear. With Bangladesh overstuffed and facing a clear shortage of available HKC yards, and with shipowners/cash buyers staying away from the DASR dance, Alang anchorage might be the one to keep an eye on — at least until Bangladesh's elections formalize, a modicum of stability starts to reign, and positive economic measures are implemented.

Currency woes.

DASR dance.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

HOT WHEELS!

Waiting to pounce.

Pakistan remains hot on the heels of its Indian neighbors/competitors, and as Bangladesh currently takes a breather, now could be the pivotal time for Gadani recyclers to step into the breach with some opportunistic vessel purchases. But will they?

Local offerings are still positioned below USD 400/LDT on a majority of the tonnage being presented locally, and it has been a fairly inert December 2025/first week of January 2026, after a promising few months in 2025 that briefly saw Gadani top the price board and have a flush anchorage to match.

Below 400.

Proof of this is the state of local anchorage, which has resumed its time in solitary — mirroring India. It certainly is an eclipse moment for the ship recycling world when regional recycling anchorages west of Chattogram sit completely empty.

In the meantime, yards remain busy upgrading and improving infrastructure to fall in line with HKC standards (with one yard already approved), with the HKC now fully in force as of June last year. But this remains a major limitation for the market, especially with an expected influx of tonnage and Bangladesh largely out of the running.

Indignity.

Fundamentals, meanwhile, continue on their merry way, with local steel plate prices maintaining the status quo and the PKR losing 20 basis points, though it still managed to stay within PKR 280 territory as it wound the week down at PKR 280.62. Domestically, there was good news for the nation's economy as well with inflation reporting a sharp drop down to 5.6%, its lowest level since August 2025.

Overall, it seems this market will suffer the indignity of an HKC-short beachfront, which will more than likely see India consume most of the tonnage in the near term. New year and empty anchorages aren't how Gadani recyclers anticipated the start of 2026.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

Zzzzz!

Aliaga recyclers seems to be chilling on an extended 2025 holiday on the sidelines, with nothing more than the Lira sinking further by another 26 basis points and locking itself in firmly into TRY 43 territory, as it closes the week out at TRY 43.03.

TRY troubles.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 1 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	India	**Firming**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Steady**	390 / LDT	410 / LDT	420 / LDT
3	Bangladesh	**Weak**	380 / LDT	400 / LDT	410 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	270 / LDT	280 / LDT	290 / LDT

WOWZA!!

- *By one calculation, spending on AI accounted for 92 percent of America's GDP growth in the first half of 2025.*
- *This year, a baby with a rare genetic condition became the first child to receive a customized CRISPR gene-editing treatment to fix his specific DNA mutation.*
- *During the late 1800s, baseball players experimented with four-sided bats.*
- *And in the early 1970s, Little League tried to prevent girls from playing baseball by saying that being hit with a ball could cause breast cancer.*
- *On a single day in 1900, a former schoolteacher destroyed three saloons using bricks, rocks, and a billiard ball—all to advance the cause of temperance.*
- *When the New Jersey Meadowlands was a dump site, it accepted rubble from the London Blitz and the Doric columns of New York's old Penn Station (along with toxic manufacturing sludge and standard garbage).*
- *Amtrak trains couldn't run between Albany and the Berkshires for several months this year because of a six-foot-deep sinkhole.*
- *Insects likely make up more than half of all animal species, but roughly 80 percent have never been documented by researchers.*
- *Malibu has a flock of wild parrots that may descend from pets that escaped homes during a fire in 1961.*
- *A hawk learned how to use crosswalk signals as a cue to ambush its prey*
- *A Danish study from 2018 found that tennis players lived longer than swimmers, cyclists, and joggers.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 31 – New Year's Eve January 01 – New Years Day January 14 – Pongal January 26 – Republic Day	January 01 – January 08 January 17 – January 24 January 30 – February 06

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 31 – Bank Holiday **No Holidays in January**	January 03 – January 06 January 21 – January 24

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
No more holidays in January	**No more holidays in January**

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ALANG - Port Position as of January 02, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
		No new vessels reported.		
Morality		-		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of January 02, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Gold Origin	2,486	General Cargo	Arrived January 02
2	K Asia	29,686	LNG / Gas Carrier	Arrived December 31
3	*Maple (Under Tow)*	*1,302*	*Tanker*	*Delivered January 01*
4	Victor	6,086	Bulk Carrier	Arrived January 02
		39,560		

GADANI - Port Position as of January 02, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
		No new vessels reported.		
Total Tonnage		-		

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AWAITING UPDATED FIGURES

www.gmsinc.net GMS_Leadership GMS Leadership snp@gmsinc.net

Athens, Greece Tel: +30.210.899.0669
Cumberland, USA Tel: +1.301.759.9240
Hamburg, Germany Tel: +49.40. 3197.9963
Shanghai, China Tel: +86.216.075.1900
Singapore Tel: +65.6823.8037
Bhavnagar, India Tel: +91.278.300.5253
Dubai, UAE Tel: +971.4.423.0720
New York, USA: +1.240.505.9716
Seoul, South Korea Tel: +82.10.4650.0720
Tokyo, Japan Tel: +81.3.5453.6311